DEVELOPER MIGRATION PLAN

Shopify migration plan from a development perspective

A practical plan for moving Particle for Men to Shopify, including the short meeting version and the detailed technical workstreams behind it.

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Use the first slides for the meeting summary, then keep the later slides as backup detail.

Executive Summary

Development view: a Shopify migration is possible, but it must be run as a controlled migration project with proof phases before full build. The risky areas are subscriptions, saved payments, URLs, historical data, upsells, and fulfillment logic.

GOOD FIT

Standard commerce

Products, collections, basic checkout, payments, shipping, discounts, and admin operations can move well to Shopify.

NEEDS PROOF

Custom flows

Subscriptions, post-purchase upsells, fulfillment exports, landing pages, and account behavior need real tests.

BIGGEST RISK

Revenue continuity

The launch must protect SEO traffic, active subscriptions, payment success, and warehouse processing.

Short Plan For Meeting

1 Audit current flows
List products, URLs, subscriptions, customers, orders, upsells, fulfillment, and integrations.

2 Prove high-risk items
Test subscription migration, saved payments, SEO redirects, upsells, and warehouse export before build.

3 Choose Shopify model
Decide Shopify plan, theme/headless approach, subscription app, upsell app, and landing page approach.

4 Build Shopify store
Create storefront, product templates, cart, checkout settings, content templates, and tracking.

5 Migrate and validate data
Move products, customers, historical orders, subscriptions, SEO data, and redirects with reconciliation reports.

6 Connect operations
Configure payments, shipping, taxes, reviews, loyalty, email, fraud, support, and fulfillment exports.

7 Run full QA
Test every purchase path, subscription path, payment method, mobile flow, redirect, and warehouse handoff.

8 Launch and stabilize
Freeze old site, run final import, switch DNS, monitor 404s, payments, subscriptions, orders, and support tickets.

Meeting summary: Shopify is not just a theme project, it is a data, SEO, subscription, and operations migration.

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Decision Gates Before Full Build

Gate	What Must Be Proven	Why It Matters
Subscription migration	Active subscriptions, renewal dates, prices, discounts, and payment tokens can move or be reauthorized.	Subscription revenue can be disrupted if customers must manually restart too many plans.
SEO and URLs	All valuable URLs have a redirect or equivalent Shopify page strategy.	Organic traffic loss can be expensive and slow to recover.
Upsell behavior	Post-purchase and cart upsells work with our products, payment methods, and subscriptions.	Upsell revenue may not transfer 1:1 to Shopify apps.
Fulfillment export	Orders reach warehouses with the correct tags, addresses, SKUs, quantities, and statuses.	Operations must not break after launch.
Historical data	Customers and support team can find past orders, refunds, notes, and subscription history.	Support and reporting need reliable history after migration.

Summary: these gates should be passed with real sample data before committing to the full migration.

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Development Workstreams

STOREFRONT

Customer-facing build

- Theme or headless frontend
- Product and collection pages
- Cart and checkout handoff
- Landing pages and tracking

DATA

Migration tooling

- Products and variants
- Customers and accounts
- Orders and refunds
- Subscriptions and redirects

OPERATIONS

Business systems

- Payments and fraud
- Fulfillment exports
- Email, loyalty, reviews
- Support and reporting

VALIDATION

QA workstream

Every major flow must be tested against the current website behavior, including mobile, subscriptions, upsells, discounts, and warehouse handoff.

LAUNCH

Cutover workstream

Launch needs a freeze window, final sync, DNS plan, rollback decision point, live monitoring, and support coverage.

Summary: the project should run as parallel workstreams, not a single linear theme build.

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Phase 1: Discovery And Mapping

AUDIT

- Export all URLs and categorize by page type, traffic, revenue, and SEO value.
- Map products, variants, bundles, kits, landing pages, content pages, and redirects.
- Document purchase flows, subscription flows, upsells, account actions, refunds, and support actions.
- List every integration: payments, fraud, warehouse, reviews, loyalty, email, analytics, marketplaces, and support.

DELIVERABLES

- Current-state flow document.
- Shopify fit/gap matrix.
- Full URL and redirect inventory.
- Data migration inventory.
- Integration replacement plan.
- Risk register with owners and test plans.

Summary: this phase prevents surprises by making hidden WooCommerce behavior visible before Shopify build starts.

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Phase 2: Risk Validation

This phase should use real sample data, not assumptions. The goal is to prove whether Shopify can support the business-critical flows before we spend heavily on implementation.

Build test store

Create a private Shopify test store with sample products, payment setup, subscription app, upsell app, and app candidates.

Run sample imports

Import representative customers, orders, products, discounts, and subscriptions. Record what works and what needs custom handling.

Test critical flows

Run checkout, subscription purchase, renewal, upsell acceptance, refund, failed payment, and warehouse export scenarios.

Summary: risk validation is the difference between a planned migration and a launch surprise.

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SEO And URL Migration

RISK

Shopify has fixed URL patterns for products, collections, blogs, and pages. Existing WooCommerce URLs may not be preserved exactly.

- Build full redirect map from old URL to Shopify URL.
- Preserve metadata, titles, descriptions, canonicals, image alt text, and structured data where possible.
- Check language/country URL behavior and hreflang if applicable.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Top traffic and revenue URLs have approved destination URLs.
- Redirects work in bulk tests before launch.
- New sitemaps are clean and submitted after launch.
- 404 monitoring is active from day one.
- SEO traffic is monitored daily after launch.

Summary: SEO migration should be treated as a revenue protection workstream.

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Customer And Order Data

TASKS

- Export customers, addresses, tags, marketing consent, account status, and custom fields.
- Export orders, line items, discounts, refunds, taxes, shipping, payment status, fulfillment status, notes, and metadata.
- Transform data into Shopify import format and metafields where needed.
- Create failed-record reports and reconciliation reports.
- Decide whether all history lives in Shopify or some remains in an archive/reporting system.

OPEN QUESTIONS

- Can old order IDs be preserved, or do we need a visible legacy order ID field?
- How will support search old orders after launch?
- Which custom customer fields must be available in Shopify admin?
- Which records are required for accounting, legal, and customer service?

Summary: data migration is not only import count, it must preserve support, reporting, and operational usability.

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Subscriptions And Saved Payments

HIGHEST RISK

Active subscriptions depend on product mapping, renewal schedules, prices, discounts, customer records, and saved payment tokens. Not all saved payment details can always be transferred into Shopify.

- Choose subscription app and confirm migration process.
- Run sample migration with real subscription shapes.
- Validate renewals, skipped orders, failed payments, cancellations, and discount behavior.
- Prepare customer reauthorization flow if saved payment details cannot move.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Subscription counts reconcile before and after import.
- Next billing dates are correct.
- Recurring prices and discounts are correct.
- Customers can manage subscriptions after launch.
- Support has a clear process for failed or unmigrated subscriptions.

Summary: subscriptions should be proven before the migration is approved as feasible.

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Storefront Build

TEMPLATES

- Homepage
- Product pages
- Collection pages
- Landing pages
- Content/blog pages
- Account pages

UX FLOWS

- Cart drawer or cart page
- Product selectors
- Subscription selectors
- Upsell placements
- Mobile navigation
- Trust and review blocks

PERFORMANCE

- Image optimization
- Script cleanup
- App load monitoring
- Mobile speed testing
- Core Web Vitals checks
- Tracking script control

Summary: the storefront must be built for speed, but app-heavy Shopify builds need strict performance control.

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Commerce Configuration

SHOPIFY SETUP

- Products, variants, SKUs, images, collections, tags, and metafields.
- Markets, currencies, languages, taxes, shipping zones, and shipping rates.
- Payment gateways, wallet options, fraud rules, and checkout branding.
- Discounts, coupons, bundles, selling plans, and gift/loyalty behavior.

VALIDATION

- Compare prices and discounts with current site.
- Confirm checkout works for each major payment method.
- Confirm taxes and shipping match expected regions.
- Confirm subscription products and one-time products behave correctly together.

Summary: Shopify admin configuration is a major build task, not a quick setting pass.

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Apps And Integrations

Area	Development Tasks	Validation
Email and SMS	Connect customer events, checkout events, subscription events, and segmentation.	Confirm events trigger the right flows without duplicate sends.
Reviews and loyalty	Migrate review display, loyalty points, rewards, coupons, and customer tags.	Confirm customer balances and coupon behavior.
Fraud and payments	Configure fraud tools, payment statuses, risk tags, and manual review rules.	Confirm held orders and approved orders follow the right path.
Fulfillment	Connect warehouse export, SKU mapping, order tags, address data, and fulfillment status sync.	Confirm test orders arrive correctly in warehouse flow.
Analytics	Set up pixels, server-side events if needed, attribution, and ecommerce tracking.	Confirm purchase, subscription, and upsell events are accurate.

Summary: every app must be tested as part of the customer journey, not only installed.

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Custom Development

LIKELY CUSTOM WORK

- Custom fulfillment export logic if no app matches current rules.
- Custom order/customer tagging and reporting fields.
- Custom data migration scripts and validation reports.
- Custom landing page sections if page-builder output is too limited or slow.
- Custom app proxy or middleware for workflows Shopify apps cannot cover.

NOT SAFE TO ASSUME

- That a Shopify app can copy every current flow exactly.
- That post-purchase offers work with every payment method and subscription case.
- That order history imports will look native to support staff.
- That saved payment methods can always be transferred without customer action.

Summary: custom development fills Shopify gaps, but each gap adds cost, testing, and maintenance.

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QA And Acceptance Testing

CUSTOMER QA

- Mobile and desktop browsing
- One-time checkout
- Subscription checkout
- Account login/reset
- Subscription management
- Discount and coupon use

OPERATIONS QA

- Payment capture
- Fraud review
- Refunds
- Fulfillment export
- Order status updates
- Support order lookup

MIGRATION QA

- Product counts
- Customer counts
- Order counts
- Subscription counts
- Redirect tests
- Analytics events

Summary: acceptance testing should compare Shopify behavior against the current business behavior, not only check if pages load.

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Launch Runbook

1. **Pre-launch freeze**
   Define cutoff for content, products, orders, and subscription changes.

2. **Final data sync**
   Run final exports/imports and reconcile products, customers, orders, and subscriptions.

3. **Go/no-go checks**
   Validate checkout, payments, redirects, warehouse export, analytics, and support access.

4. **DNS switch**
   Point production traffic to Shopify and confirm SSL, domain, sitemap, and redirects.

5. **Live order watch**
   Monitor real orders, payment status, fraud status, fulfillment export, and customer issues.

6. **Rollback decision**
   Define the point where issues require rollback or hotfix instead of continuing.

Summary: launch must be a rehearsed checklist with owners, not an ad hoc DNS switch.

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Post-Launch Stabilization

FIRST 72 HOURS

- Monitor checkout errors, payment failures, subscription issues, warehouse export failures, and 404s.
- Review customer support tickets several times per day.
- Fix critical data, redirect, payment, and fulfillment issues immediately.
- Compare order volume and conversion rate against normal baseline.

FIRST 30 DAYS

- Review organic traffic, conversion rate, page speed, subscription churn, upsell revenue, and support volume.
- Improve redirects and landing pages based on Search Console and analytics.
- Clean up failed imports and edge cases.
- Decide what additional custom Shopify development is needed.

Summary: migration is not finished at DNS switch, it needs active stabilization after launch.

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Timeline And Team Shape

Stage	Typical Duration	Team Needed	Output
Discovery	2-4 weeks	Developer, ecommerce lead, operations, SEO, support	Fit/gap plan, redirect inventory, integration plan, risk register.
Proof phase	2-4 weeks	Developer, Shopify/app specialist, subscriptions/payment owner	Validated subscription, SEO, upsell, fulfillment, and data samples.
Build phase	8-16+ weeks	Frontend, Shopify developer, migration developer, QA, SEO	Storefront, apps, custom logic, migration scripts, QA environment.
Launch phase	1-2 weeks	Full project team plus support and operations	Final migration, DNS switch, live monitoring, critical fixes.
Stabilization	2-4 weeks	Developers, QA, SEO, support, operations	Issue cleanup, performance tuning, reporting review, redirect improvements.

Summary: timeline depends mostly on subscription/payment migration, app fit, data quality, and custom fulfillment needs.

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Key Risks To Present

MAIN RISKS

- SEO loss from changed URLs or incomplete redirects.
- Subscription disruption if payment details cannot migrate cleanly.
- Historical order data may not look or behave exactly like native Shopify orders.
- Post-purchase and cart upsells may be limited by apps or payment methods.
- Fulfillment export logic may require custom development.
- Too many apps can slow the storefront and create maintenance risk.

CONTROLS

- Run proof-of-risk phase before full approval.
- Use real sample data for migration testing.
- Build a full redirect map and monitor 404s after launch.
- Prepare customer communication for password or payment reauthorization.
- Run launch rehearsal and keep rollback decision criteria clear.
- Track conversion, speed, subscriptions, and support tickets after launch.

Summary: Shopify can be considered, but the risky flows must be proven before the business commits.

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